Podcast Guest Booking Kit

The fit-first method for getting booked as a podcast guest: word-for-word pitch and follow-ups, the tracker that stops you spamming, and the rules that tell you when to walk away.

1. What this kit is (and what it is not)

This kit is the paperwork and the discipline behind one specific goal: being invited onto podcasts as a guest, and being invited back. It contains five scripts you read or paste almost as written (a pitch, two follow-ups, a confirmation brief, and a post-appearance note), the method that decides which shows are worth any of those words, and a companion workbook that tracks every show so nothing depends on memory. Together they replace the two failure modes that make most guest outreach worthless: sending the same generic email to everyone, and following up so often that a producer filters you forever.

The single idea underneath everything that follows: **a pitch is a guess about fit, and fit is decided by the host's audience, not by you.** Every step below exists to make each pitch a smaller, better-informed guess - and to stop you sending the ones that are simply wrong.

What it is not: it is not a placement service. Nothing here submits you to a database, buys you a slot, or contacts anyone on your behalf. It cannot promise a booking, because reply rates depend on your topics, your evidence and the host's current calendar - no template controls any of those. It is not PR, legal or financial advice, and it does not write your story for you.

2. The principle - fit before pitch

Producers do not read pitches looking for a person to say yes to. They read them looking for a reason to stop reading, because their inbox is full of people who did not do the work. The fastest way to stop being one of those people is to only pitch shows where you can name the episode that proves you listen. If you cannot name an episode, you have not done the research, and the producer will know within two lines.

This is why the method starts with assets and a target list, and reaches the pitch email only at step two. A pitch sent before you can state your angle, your proof and your offer is not outreach; it is a coin flip with your name on it.

3. Step 0 - build three assets before you pitch anyone

Do this once. It is the same work for every show, so an hour here saves a bad first impression at every show on your list.

- **Three angles (not one topic).** An angle is a specific, arguable, useful claim for a named audience, e.g. 'the three pricing mistakes that make freelancers undercharge on fixed bids'. 'I talk about freelancing' is not an angle. Write three to six in the Angles sheet, each with the concrete proof you can cite for it (a number, a story, an outcome) and the show type it best fits.
- **A one-sheet.** One page a host can scan in 30 seconds: what you talk about, three topic lines, a short bio, your proof, and your logistics (timezone, remote-ready, episode length you can carry). Keep it under 250 words of actual prose. It is a filter, not a CV.

- **Your bio at three lengths,** 60, 150 and 300 words, ready to paste. Most hosts ask at the worst moment, and some ask for 60 words when you only have a paragraph written.
- **A lead magnet,** one free, genuinely useful thing you can offer the audience (a checklist, a template, a calculator). This is the line that turns 'why should I care' into 'what is in it for my listeners'.

Record all four in the workbook's Assets sheet and mark each one Ready. The sheet will not let the kit pretend you are ready when a required asset is blank.

4. Step 1 - build a target list of 25 to 40 shows, not 200

Volume is the wrong lever. Forty shows you have actually listened to beat two hundred you scraped off a chart, because the forty let you write a specific line and the two hundred force a template. Build the list in the workbook's Pipeline sheet, one row per show.

Six fit signals - score each show 1 (poor) to 5 (strong) before you rank the list:

- **Audience overlap.** The listeners are the people your angle is for, not just people in a broad industry.
- **Recent activity.** Episodes in the last 60 days; a dormant show cannot book you.
- **Guest format.** It regularly features guests (some shows are solo by design - pitching them wastes both your time).
- **Topic gap.** Your angle is close to what they cover but not something they published in the last few months.
- **Length and cadence.** Episode length you can genuinely carry well.
- **Reachable.** A real contact route (a producer, a contact form, or a public email) - not a guess.

The cut rule. Anything scoring 3 or below is deleted, not queued. A short list you finish is worth more than a long list you never work, and a poorly fitted pitch is not neutral - it spends your name in that host's inbox.

5. Step 2 - the pitch

One email. Under 120 words in the body. No attachments on the first contact (a one-sheet link is fine; an attached PDF is a spam signal in some filters and a decision to defer in every inbox). Name the specific episode you heard, state one angle and its proof, say what you offer the audience, give two concrete availability windows, and ask one low-commitment question.

Subject: guest idea for [Show]: [your angle in under 8 words]

Hi [Name],

I listened to [Episode title, date] - the part about [one specific detail] is why I am writing.

One angle for your listeners: [angle in one sentence], and I can back it with [one concrete number or story].

I bring [lead magnet] for your audience, no strings.

I am free [date/time window 1] or [date/time window 2], 30 minutes either way.

Worth a short fit call, or would you rather I send the one-pager first?

- [You], [one-line credential], [one link]

Why each line is there. The subject names the show and the angle so it is obviously not a blast. The second line proves you listened - it is the only line that cannot be faked cheaply. The third line is the actual offer, stated as a claim you can support. The lead-magnet line answers 'what is in it for my listeners'. The two windows remove a scheduling round-trip. The closing question is deliberately easy to answer with one word, which is the most you can realistically ask of a stranger.

Non-negotiable rules: one pitch per show per quarter; never the same angle to two shows on the same network in the same week; never a mass mail with no episode reference; never ask to 'pick your brain' - offer an angle instead.

6. Step 3 - exactly two follow-ups, then close

Most bookings come from the follow-up. Most blocks come from the third one. So the cadence is fixed: one follow-up on day 7, one on day 21, then you stop - permanently, unless they reply.

FOLLOW-UP 1 - day 7

Subject: Re: guest idea for [Show]

Hi [Name], adding one thing rather than just bumping this: [new proof since last week - one line, a result, a new resource, a timely hook].

If the angle misses, tell me what you ARE booking right now and I will either fit it or bow out.

- [You]

FOLLOW-UP 2 AND CLOSE - day 21

Subject: closing the loop - [Show]

Hi [Name], last note from me. I am closing my outreach for [quarter] on [day]. If [angle] ever fits your calendar, my one-pager is here: [link] - the offer stands.

Either way, thank you for the episodes. - [You]

Why two. The first follow-up adds information, which is a reason to reply. The second closes the loop with dignity, which is the only move that preserves a future yes. A third is not persistence; it is a request to be filtered. In the workbook, the two due dates are computed from the pitch date automatically, so the cadence cannot drift and 'overdue' is visible rather than remembered.

7. Step 4 - the yes: confirm, prepare, protect the recording

A yes is not a booking until the details are in writing. Send the confirmation brief the same day, and keep it short enough that a busy host can reply to it from a phone.

CONFIRMATION BRIEF - send within 24 hours of the yes

Subject: [Show] - [date] at [time] [timezone]: what to expect

Recording: [date], [start-end], [timezone], [platform/link]. Backup: [phone or second platform].

Format: [solo interview / panel], about [length], audio / video.

Agreed angle: [angle]. If useful, I can also bring [second angle].

Prep: 3 sample questions attached or pasted below; I do not need them in advance.

Promo: I will share the episode with [audience/channels] on release day. Anything you want said about your show, tell me and I will say exactly that.

Reschedule: if something changes, [contact] up to [hours] before is fine.

- [You]

■ Write 5 to 8 real questions you would enjoy answering; they help a host who is short on prep and cost you nothing.

■ Run a 60-second tech check on the exact platform, on the exact device, the day before.

■ Headphones on, phone silenced, notifications off, and a backup way to reach the host if the link fails.

■ Have your 60-word bio and one link copied to the clipboard before you join.

■ Have one clear, honest call to action ready for the end. Rehearse it once - a rambled CTA wastes the whole appearance.

8. Fill these in once: your one-sheet and your question bank

Two pages pay for themselves at every show, so build them before you pitch and reuse them for the rest of the year.

8.1 The one-sheet. One page, under 250 words of prose, in this order. Fill the block below, save it as a PDF, put it on a link, and never attach it to a first pitch.

Your name + one-line credential (who you are, in 12 words) _____
Three topic lines, each a specific claim with its proof _____ _____ _____
Short bio (60 words) - what you do, who for, what changed _____ _____ _____
Proof: the two numbers, results or names you can cite on air _____ _____
Logistics: timezone, remote-ready, episodes lengths you can carry _____ _____
The two links you allow, and the lead magnet you offer _____ _____

8.2 The question bank. A guest who brings real questions is the easiest guest to book again, because the host has less prep to do. Write at least eight you would enjoy answering; below are the shapes that work, so replace each with your own specifics.

- **Origin:** the moment you first noticed the problem your angle is about.
- **Belief:** the common advice in your field you think is wrong, and what you suggest instead.
- **Method:** the exact steps of your approach, in order, for a listener starting today.
- **Evidence:** the result or number that proves the method works, and how you measured it.
- **Failure:** a time your approach did not work, and what you changed afterwards.
- **Objection:** the reason a listener would say 'this will not work for me', answered honestly.
- **Cost of inaction:** what staying on the current path actually costs, in money or time.
- **Action:** the one thing a listener can do in the next hour to start.
- **Story:** one specific person you helped, told in a sentence - without their identity.
- **Contrarian:** a prediction about where your field is going, with the reasoning.

9. Step 5 - after the appearance (within 24 hours)

THANK-YOU AND ASSETS - within 24 hours of recording

Subject: thank you - assets for [Episode]

Thanks for having me on - that was genuinely enjoyable.

Assets you may want: headshot [link], short bio [link], and my links, two at most: [link 1], [link 2].

I shared the recording with [audience] today and will point to the episode again on release day.

If a part 2 on [specific angle] is ever useful, I am in. - [You]

The give-back matters more than the ask. Point your own audience at the episode, quote the host once, and offer a specific part-2 angle - a specific offer is far more likely to be remembered than 'let's do this again sometime'. Then log the outcome in the workbook so the cycle that produced the yes is visible in your numbers.

10. The weekly ritual and how to read your own numbers

Once a week, forty-five minutes, in this order: rank any new shows and cut the weak ones; send this week's pitches; work the follow-ups the sheet marks due; update statuses honestly; then look at the Metrics sheet for thirty seconds before you close it.

- **Reply rate** tells you whether your fit and your subject lines work. A low rate with a good list means the pitch, not the list.
- **Booking rate** tells you whether your angle lands with the hosts who do reply.
- **Per-angle reply rate** tells you which of your three angles is actually wanted. Kill the weakest angle after roughly 15 pitches, do not defend it.
- **Closed without reply** is not failure and should not be hidden - it is the honest baseline your next quarter is measured against.

Judge batches, not individual emails. Ten pitches is noise; thirty is a signal. Change one thing at a time (angle, or subject line, not both) so a later improvement has a cause you can name.

11. The first 14 days, if you are starting today

If a blank tracker is the reason nothing has happened yet, book fourteen days in your calendar and do exactly this. The first fortnight is deliberately about building the assets and a real list, not about volume.

- **Day 1-2.** Choose three angles and write each as a specific claim plus its proof. Reject any angle you cannot support with a number, a result or a named experience.
- **Day 3.** Build the one-sheet from section 8.1 - one page, under 250 words of prose, one link and one lead magnet.
- **Day 4.** Write your eight-plus question bank from section 8.2. This is the asset that makes a host want you back.
- **Day 5-6.** Build a target list of 30 shows in your subject's world. Listen to one episode of each and note the episode you will reference.
- **Day 7.** Score every show against the six fit signals and cut everything at 3 or below. A shorter, honest list beats a long, indifferent one.
- **Day 8.** Write the pitch for each remaining show in its own words, with its own episode reference and one scheduling line.
- **Day 9-10.** Send the first batch, no more than ten, and log the send date, show, angle and subject line.
- **Day 11-13.** Work the follow-ups the tracker marks due. Do not send a third.
- **Day 14.** Read the Metrics sheet once. Note your reply rate, which angle earned replies, and one change you will make to the next batch - then stop, and repeat the week.

Nothing here requires an audience, a sponsor or a paid tool. It requires a real list, a specific angle and a kept log.

12. Worked example (illustrative)

The following is a fictional illustration of the method, not a real person or show. A bookkeeping-automation consultant wants to guest on small-business shows. Instead of a topic, she writes an angle: 'the three recurring admin jobs a small business can automate in a week without hiring anyone', with proof: '23 small businesses audited, average 9 hours a week recovered'. She builds a target list of 31 shows, cuts 12 that score 3 or below, and pitches the remaining 19 - each time naming the episode she heard.

Subject: guest idea for The Small Biz Kitchen: automating three admin jobs

Hi Marisol,

I heard your episode with the bakery owner about drowning in paperwork - the part about invoicing at 11pm is why I am writing.

One angle for your listeners: the three recurring admin jobs a small business can automate in a week without hiring anyone, backed by 23 audits where owners got back about 9 hours a week on average.

I bring a one-page 'which job first' checklist your listeners can use the same day.

I am free Tuesday 10am or Thursday 2pm, 30 minutes either way.

Worth a short fit call, or would you rather I send the one-pager first?

- [Name], small-business automation, [link]

- Of 19 pitches, the honest expectation is a minority of replies and fewer bookings - the point of the numbers is to measure that minority, not to pretend it is larger.
- Two angles outperformed the third, so the third was retired after about 15 sends and the strongest angle was split into two more specific ones.
- Three shows that never replied are kept as closed, dated, and untouched for a quarter - a future, better-timed pitch is legitimate; a third follow-up is not.

13. Ten mistakes that get you ignored

- Pitching a show you have never listened to - the missing episode reference is always visible.
- Leading with your bio instead of the audience's benefit.
- Sending a wall of text, or a 500-word bio, unasked.
- Attaching files on first contact.
- Pitching the same angle to two shows on one network in the same week.
- Following up a third time. Two, then stop.
- Vague angles ('I talk about leadership') that give the host nothing to schedule.
- No lead magnet - so the host has nothing to offer their audience on your behalf.
- Asking to 'pick your brain', which asks for time and offers none.
- Tracking nothing, so you cannot tell which angle or subject ever worked.

14. Objections, answered

'Nobody replies.' That is normal at first, and it is why the tracker exists: thirty pitches with a kept log tells you whether the list or the pitch is wrong, which guessing never does. **'I am not famous enough.'** Hosts book useful guests, not famous ones; a specific, provable angle with a real offer the audience can use beats a large following for most shows. **'I do not have a lead magnet yet.'** Then build one small, genuinely useful page first - it is the difference between 'why should I care' and 'what is in it for my listeners'. **'Two follow-ups feels too few.'** It is exactly the number that keeps the door open; the third is the one that closes it. **'What if they say no?'** A no, logged and closed, is information about your fit and your angle, and it costs you nothing you cannot try again next quarter with a better pitch.

15. What this is not

This is a working method and a set of scripts, not a service and not a promise. No purchase of this kit submits you to any database, contacts any host, or guarantees any booking, listener number or business result. Reply and booking rates depend on your topics, your evidence, the host's calendar and factors outside anyone's control; the workbook only shows you what your own logged numbers imply. Names and scenarios in the worked example are fictional illustrations. The templates are for your own guesting; do not resell or redistribute the files.

NOT A PLACEMENT SERVICE - NO BOOKING IS PROMISED OR IMPLIED. No part of this kit contacts any show on your behalf. Reply rates depend on fit, timing and your own evidence. Not PR, legal or financial advice; the worked example is fictional.